

1. Copy any empty cell that is not formatted as Text
2. Select the Column and format as any Date and/or Time format.
3. While the Column is still selected, go to **Edit > Paste Special > Add**.

This will force Excel to convert any text date and times to real dates and times. You may need to change the format again. Another simple method is to reference the cell(s) like:

=A1+0 or A1*1

This will also do the same.

3.4.2 Labels And Named Ranges

In a large workbook, if you want to go to a specific location, a great deal of worksheet-changing and scrolling can be involved. It's worse if you don't know exactly where you want to go. What if you could just type 'Total Sales', or pick from a list of places, and be transported to the exact cell you wanted? Another problem is figuring out what is going on in a formula in a spreadsheet. You read '=\$C\$6*\$B\$3', and you still don't know what you have in the cell, or what two elements are being multiplied. Wouldn't it be nice if you could read '=(Ram Sales)*Commission_Rate' instead? Or, if you're comfortable with formulas, '=SUM(Sales)' instead of '=SUM(\$C\$6:\$C\$10,\$F\$9:\$F\$14)'?

The answer is that you can have the easier-to-read version and much more by using Excel's ability to use labels and named ranges in formulas. Consider a simple example as shown below:

Commission Listing				
Commission	0.05			
Salesperson	Sales	Commission	Withdrawals	Compensation
Rensuka	9331			200
Aditya	3293.45			100
Robert	493.5			400
Preethi	49434.5			400
Ram	797.05			400

The commission rate is in cell B3 here

Imagine this listing is large enough to handle a hundred salespeople, with a commission rate in cell B3.

To begin with, the commission rate in this sheet is